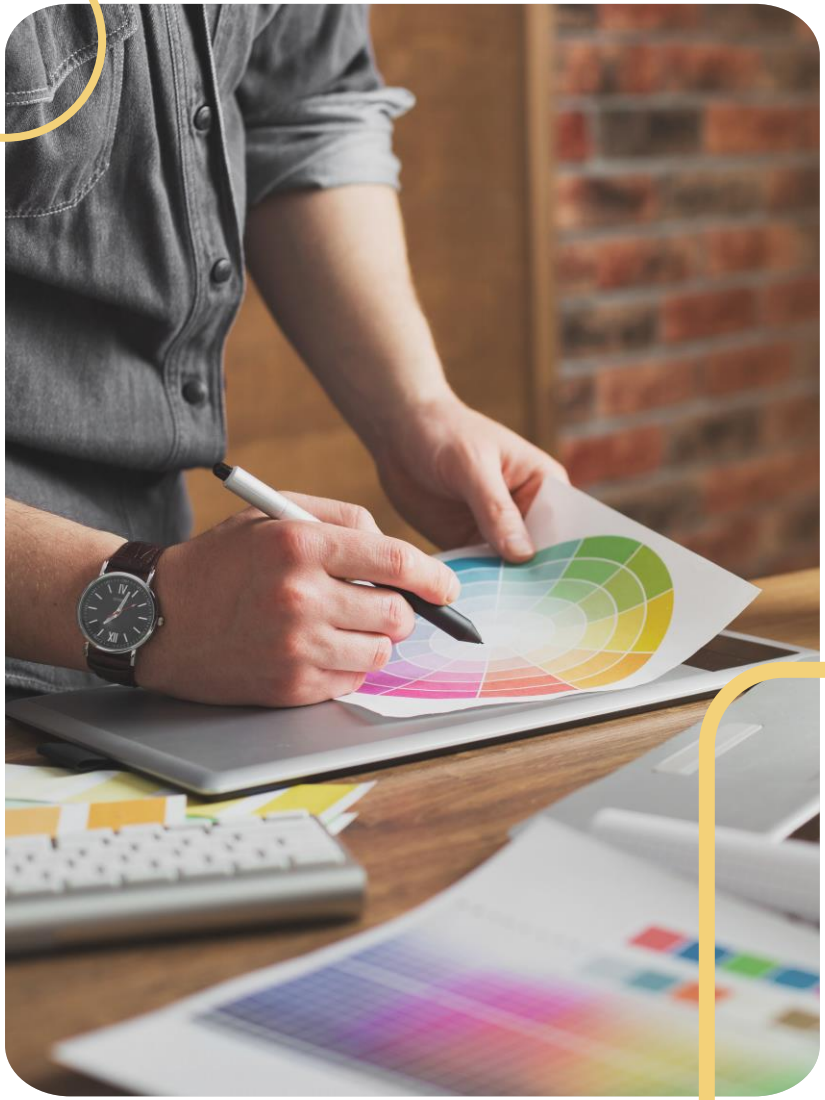
Graphic Design

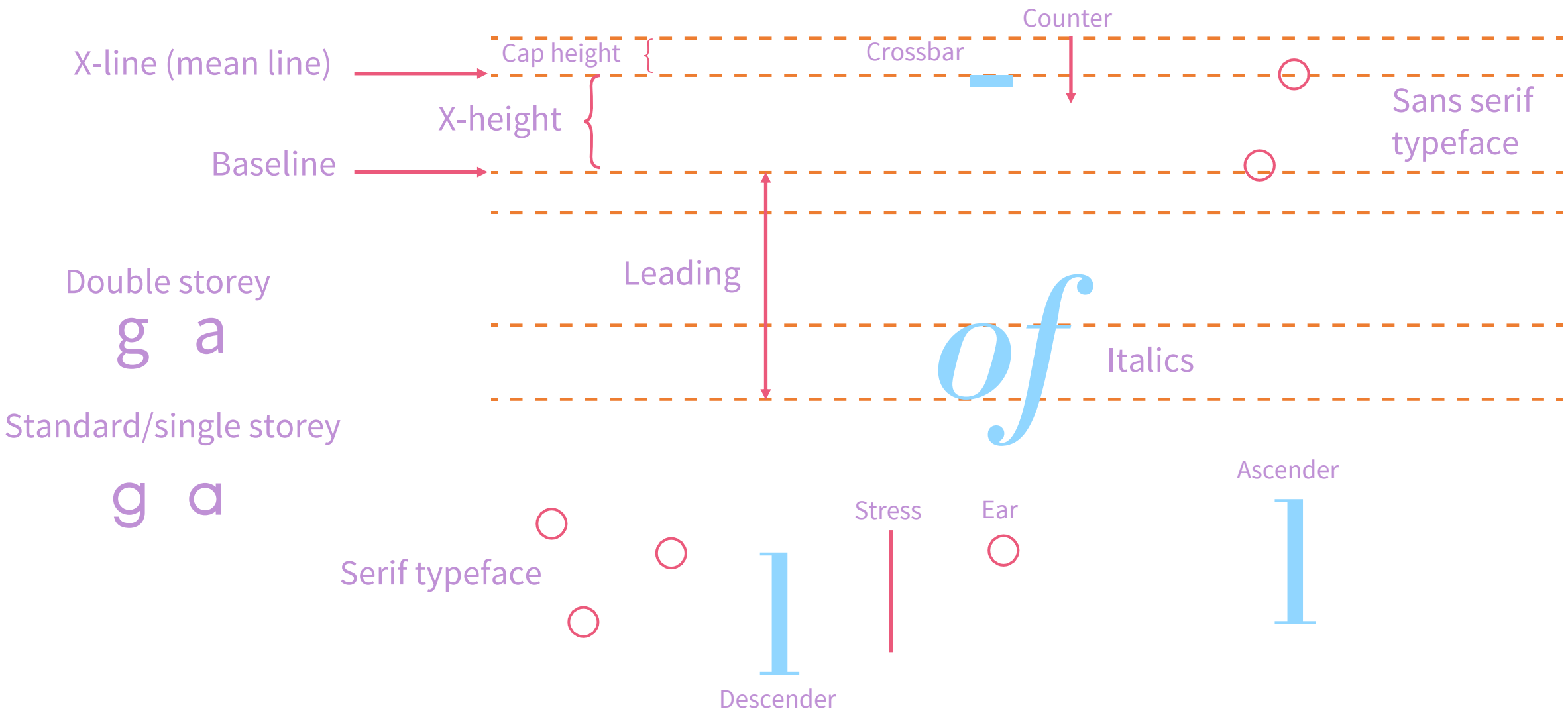
Create your own font

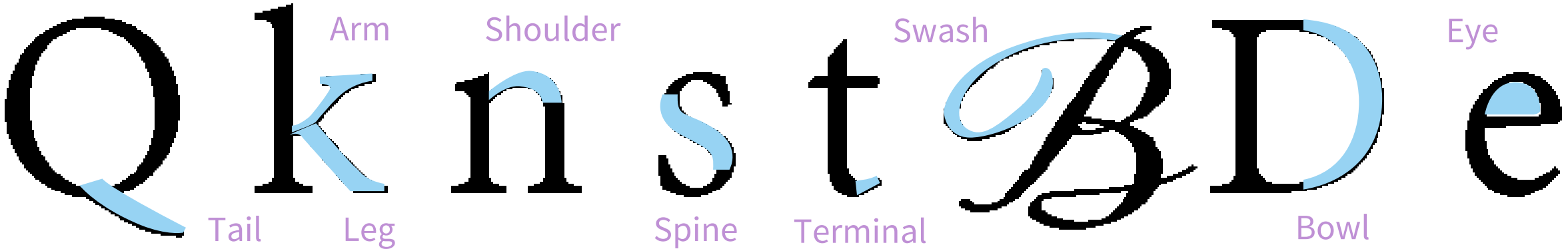


Lesson Objectives

- Recap on typography terminology
- What is a font designer?
- Font formats
- Demo: Font creation

Recap on typography anatomy


Counter
X-line (mean line)
Cap height
Crossbar
X-height
Sans serif typeface
Baseline
Leading
Double storey
g a
of
Italics
Standard/single storey
g a
Ascender
Stress
Ear
Serif typeface
Descender


Arm
Shoulder
Swash
Eye
Tail
Leg
Spine
Terminal
Bowl

Typeface categories

Serif

Sans Serif

Display

Script

Old Style

Transitional

Modern

Slab Serif

Serif Typefaces

- Traditional
- Used for body copy mostly in printed documents
- Body copy should be 8 – 10 pts & effortless to read
- Garamond & Baskerville

Lato Black

Broadway

ARYA TRIPLE

ETHNOCENTRIC

Sans Serif Typefaces

- Contemporary
- Sans is French for “without”
- No serifs
- Readable – digital use

Chiller

Copperplate

Impact

Ballet Harmony

Display Typefaces

- Used for headings
- Not suitable for body copy
- Can have serifs or not
- Understand the mood a display typeface conveys

Ballet Harmony

Palace Script

Braisetto

BRAISETTO

Braisetto

Script Typefaces

- Can be used as display typefaces
- Small amounts of copy
- Handwritten
- Don’t add kerning, tracking or all caps

Did you know?

Steve Jobs made some of the earliest digital fonts.

He named them after beloved cities: Chicago, Geneva, San Francisco

What is a font designer?

What is a font designer?

Also known as a typeface creator

Designs, develops and creates fonts

Every single character needs to be tweaked

Keen eye for detail (like graphic designers)

Fontself, FontLab or Fontographer, FontCreator, Glyphsapp (Mac only), Adobe Illustrator

Font designing software

Fontself

(Mac & Win)

FontLab

(Mac & Win)

Fontographer

(Mac & Win)

Font designing software

FontCreator

(Win only)

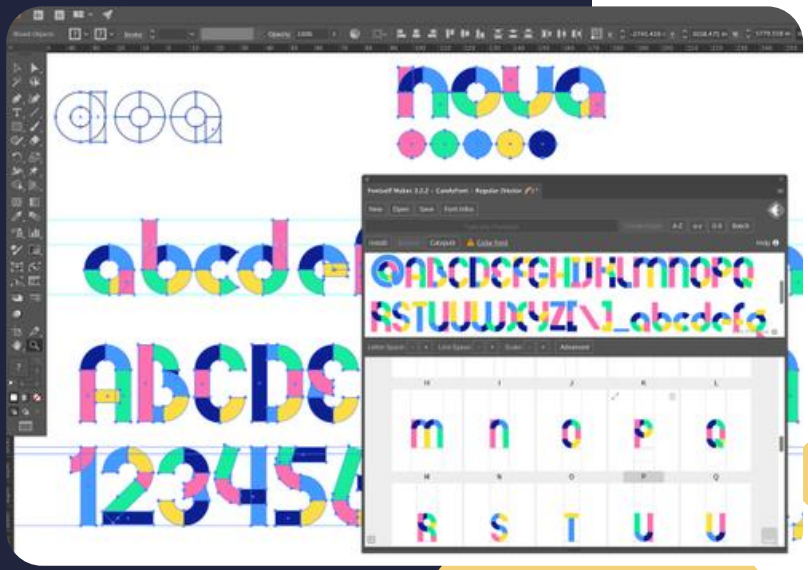
MS Font Maker

(Win only)

Font Forge

(Mac & Win)

Font formats



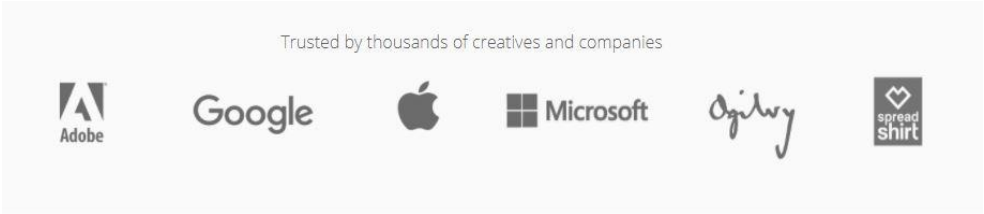
Font file types

- OTF (OpenType font file)
- TTF (TrueType font file)
- SVG (Scalable vector graphics font file)
- EOT (Embedded OpenType)
- WOFF (Web open font format)
- WOFF2 (Web open font format)
- OpenType-SVG (Colour fonts)

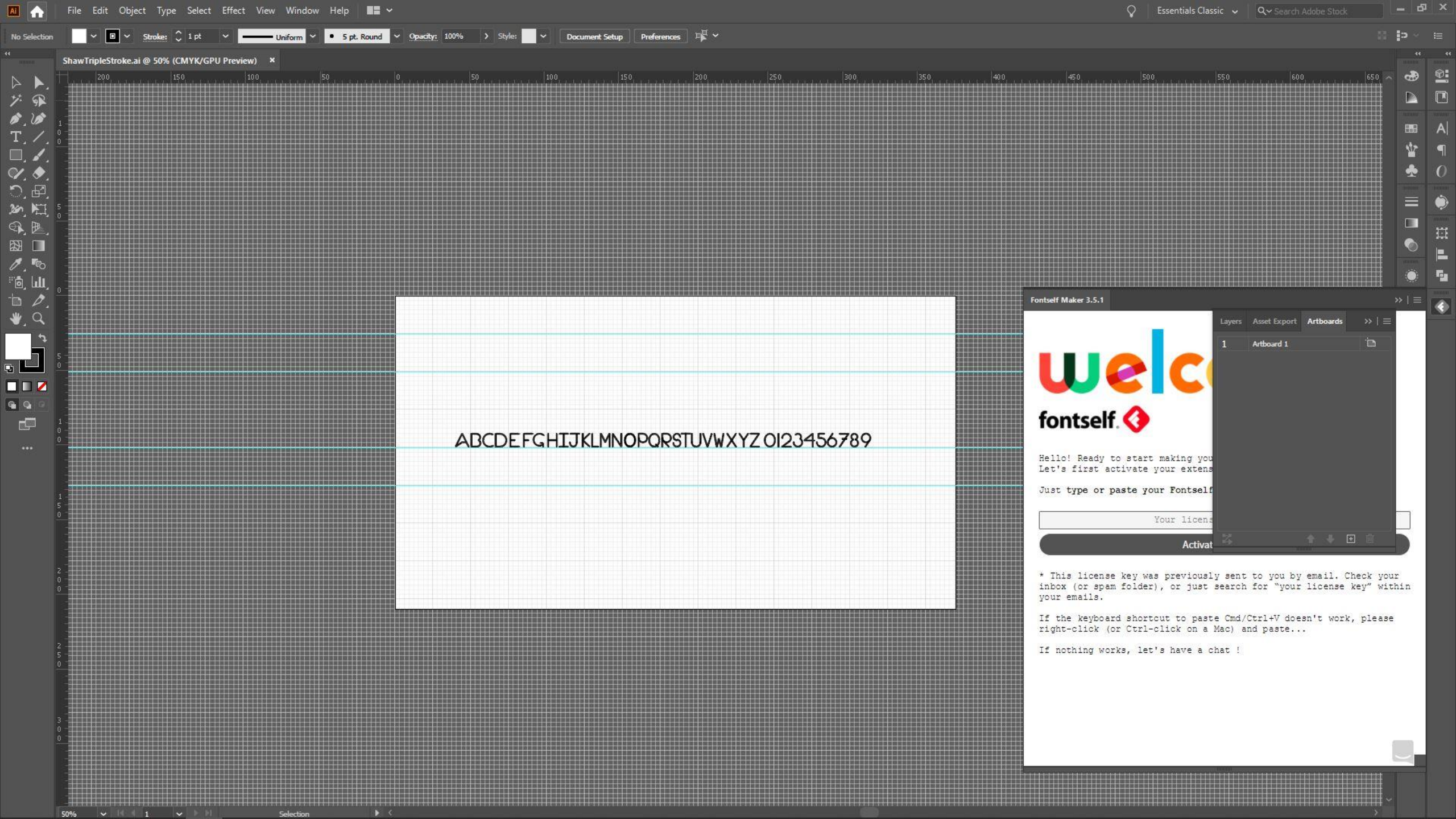
Working with Fontself

- Download and install the Fontself extension (Mac or Win)
- Create your font in Adobe ILL or PS
- Save it as OpenType-svg
- Load it into the Fontself extension
- Save as an .otf file
- Upload your Shaw Certificate to www.fontself.com to get up to 50% off

fontself©



Demo: Font creation


File Edit Object Type Select Effect View Window Help
Essentials Classic
Search Adobe Stock
No Selection
Stroke: 1 pt
Uniform
5 pt. Round
Opacity: 100%
Style:
Document Setup
Preferences
ShawTripleStroke.ai @ 50% (CMYK/GPU Preview)
ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ 0123456789
Fontself Maker 3.5.1
Layers
Asset Export
Artboards
1
Artboard 1
fontself.
Hello! Ready to start making you
Let's first activate your extens
Just type or paste your Fontself
Your licens
Activat
* This license key was previously sent to you by email. Check your inbox (or spam folder), or just search for "your license key" within your emails.
If the keyboard shortcut to paste Cmd/Ctrl+V doesn't work, please right-click (or Ctrl-click on a Mac) and paste...
If nothing works, let's have a chat !
50%
Selection

Challenge

Create your own font!

Choose a theme first

Start building by considering type anatomy and using guides